



SWMS04

Safe Work Method Statement

Work that involves, or is likely to involve, the disturbance of asbestos (observation only)

Document number	EC-SWMS04	Revision	1.0
Prepared by	Ecology Consulting — WHS / Field team	Document release date	
Approved by	Tony Webster — Managing Director / WHS Officer	Next review	

Note: Work must be performed in accordance with this Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS). This SWMS must be kept and available for inspection until the work is completed. If revised, every version must be kept. If a notifiable incident occurs in relation to the work in this SWMS, the SWMS must be kept for at least two years from the date of the notifiable incident. This SWMS is accessed and acknowledged through the Ecology Consulting digital WHS platform; field forms are submitted from site and reviewed centrally by the administration team.

Scope & limitations: Works are limited to visual ecological surveys only. **Under no circumstances will Ecology Consulting personnel disturb, handle, remove or interfere with asbestos or asbestos containing materials (ACM).** The Principal Contractor retains responsibility for asbestos identification, control and management, including the asbestos register and asbestos management plan. Ecology Consulting personnel will comply with all site controls and will not undertake asbestos-related work, ground disturbance or excavation.

Project & PCBU details

Person conducting a business or undertaking (PCBU)	Ecology Consulting Pty Ltd · ABN 68 647 633 163	Contact number	0472 569 988 (office / Check-in)
EC offices	34 Atchison St, Wollongong NSW 2500 · 42 Goulburn St, Crookwell NSW 2583 · 473 Townsend St, Albury NSW 2640		
Client / Principal Contractor			
Work activity	Visual ecological survey and observation on sites where asbestos or asbestos containing materials are known, suspected or may be present in structures, soil or fill.		
Workplace location			

Field work duration	
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Legislation, codes of practice & standards

Acts & Regulations	Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (NSW) and the Work Health and Safety Regulation (NSW); Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (Cth) and WHS Regulations 2011 (Cth) where work is on Commonwealth land or for a Commonwealth entity (Comcare jurisdiction); Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (ACT) and WHS Regulation 2011 (ACT) for works in the ACT.
Codes of Practice	Safe Work Australia model Codes as adopted in NSW and the ACT: <i>How to manage work health and safety risks; Work health and safety consultation, cooperation and coordination; Construction work; First aid in the workplace; Managing the work environment and facilities; Preparation of safe work method statements for construction work. How to manage and control asbestos in the workplace; How to safely remove asbestos; Managing risks of hazardous chemicals in the workplace.</i>
Standards & guidance	AS/NZS 1715 and AS/NZS 1716 Selection, use and maintenance of respiratory protective equipment; AS 1319 Safety signs for the occupational environment. Asbestos Awareness training is an ACT requirement and may be mandated by the Principal Contractor elsewhere.
EC WHS documentation	EC Work Health and Safety Management System and WHS Handbook; EC Risk Management Processes (EC-RMP-FRM-001); EC Hazard Register and Trigger Action Response List (TARL); Pre-Mobilisation Checklist; Pre-Travel Vehicle Safety Checklist; Journey Management Plan; Daily Toolbox Talk; site-specific Emergency Response Plan (ERP); JSA — General Field Surveys; JSA — Remote and Isolated Work; SOP — Journey Management; SOP — Terrestrial Fauna; SOP — Fieldwork Biosecurity.

Mandatory personal protective equipment & field equipment

Confirmed present and serviceable on the Pre-Mobilisation Checklist and verified by the Field Lead at the Daily Toolbox Talk. Faulty items are tagged out and removed from service.

Hard Hat	P2 Respirator	Safety Glasses	Gloves	Hearing Protection	Hi-Vis Clothing	Disposable Coveralls	Wide Brim Hat	Capped Boots
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Fire Extinguisher	Remote First Aid Kit	Snake Bite Kit	In Reach / Sat Phone	Two-Way Radio	Torch / Headlamp	GPS	Drinking Water
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Long Sleeves & Trousers	200 µm Waste Bags	Asbestos Waste Labels	Hand Wash / Sanitiser	Boot Wash	Site Asbestos Register	Site Signage & Barricades	Decontamination Point
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Hierarchy of controls

Eliminate	Avoid exposure by planning work to prevent any disturbance of ACM — remote observation, exclusion of high-risk areas, and rescheduling around asbestos removal works.
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Substitute	Use alternative methods that reduce risk where practicable — remote survey tools, aerial imagery, or existing data instead of field verification in affected areas.
Isolate	Maintain separation from asbestos through exclusion zones, barricades and restricted access areas established by the Principal Contractor.
Engineer	Rely on site-established controls such as physical barriers, containment, encapsulation, dust suppression and controlled access routes.
Administrative	Follow the asbestos register, asbestos management plan, this SWMS, site inductions and permit systems; confirm observation-only scope; implement stop-work triggers.
PPE	Last line of defence where required — P2 respirators, disposable coveralls and gloves. PPE is never the primary control for asbestos risk.

Hazards & controls

Complete for each site attendance. Any suspected asbestos triggers an immediate stop work.

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Planning, preparation and travelling to site		
Inadequate planning leading to uncontrolled risk; unfit or untrained personnel	Attend the pre-field meeting with the Project Lead and Project Manager to review scope, methodology and expected hazards; confirm site access, keys, codes, inductions and property constraints; and confirm all staff are trained, competent and fit for work. Medical concerns are disclosed privately to the Field Lead. Review this SWMS, the relevant JSA and SOP, the Field Plan and the site-specific ERP. Verify training currency — workers are not mobilised with expired mandatory training.	☐ Pre-field meeting ☐ SWMS / JSA / SOP reviewed ☐ ERP reviewed ☐ Training verified ☐ Medical disclosures
Vehicle failure, missing safety equipment or fatigue during travel	Complete the Pre-Travel Vehicle Safety Checklist — first aid kit, extinguisher, spare tyre, torch, water and PPE present; vehicle free from leaks, faults or damage; electrical issues visually inspected only and tagged out if unsafe. Complete the Journey Management Plan. Minimum 10-hour rest between shifts before driving; personal fatigue self-assessment before departure; rest breaks every two hours; carry water, snacks and electrolytes; second driver for long or remote trips where practicable. Zero blood alcohol concentration applies to all work driving.	☐ Vehicle checklist done ☐ JMP completed ☐ 10-hr rest confirmed ☐ Fatigue self-assessment
Travelling into fire, flood, storm, smoke or hazardous road conditions	Complete the Pre-Travel Environmental and Hazard Check using BOM weather warnings, Hazards Near Me, RFS fire danger ratings, Air Quality Index, lightning trackers, Live Traffic NSW and telecommunications coverage maps. Do not travel where there are emergency warning fire events, hazardous air quality, active storm warnings or flooded roads. Never drive through floodwater under any circumstance. If conditions change, stop, reassess and notify the Communication Officer.	☐ BOM / Hazards Near Me ☐ RFS rating checked ☐ AQI checked ☐ Live Traffic NSW ☐ Coverage checked
Hazards not identified, assessed or communicated before work commences	All team members participate in a pre-commencement Daily Toolbox Talk led on site by the Field Lead and documented on the EC WHS form — site-specific hazards identified; collaborative risk assessment using the EC risk matrix (rating one to six) with agreed controls and a revised residual rating; PPE and equipment readiness confirmed; ERP reviewed and Emergency Meeting Point identified; communication and check-in requirements confirmed; health or access needs disclosed privately; and worker sign-on confirming understanding and fitness for work. Hazards already in the EC Hazard Register are managed under the TARL. No worker commences without sign-on.	☐ Toolbox talk held ☐ Risk assessment rated ☐ Emergency Meeting Point ☐ All workers signed on
Loss of contact with the field team; delayed emergency response	Mandatory check-ins with the Communication Officer (0472 569 988) before departing base, on arrival at site or accommodation, before leaving site, and on return to base. Every check-in must be acknowledged. A missed or unacknowledged check-in triggers escalation through the Communication Officer, Project Lead or Project Manager, and the WHS Officer, and is grounds for activating the ERP. Carry redundant communications — mobile phone, UHF radio and In Reach or satellite communicator, with a PLB where remoteness warrants. Roles are assigned at the toolbox talk: Field Lead, Communication Officer and workers.	☐ Check-in schedule agreed ☐ Comms tested ☐ Roles assigned ☐ Escalation briefed
Planning and consultation		

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Unidentified asbestos, contaminated soil or ACM in structures; incomplete or outdated information; exposure due to poor planning	Contact the client prior to scheduling fieldwork and request information on known contamination. Obtain and review the asbestos register and asbestos management plan and confirm they are current. Confirm areas of asbestos and exclusion zones before mobilisation. Ensure the Principal Contractor communicates all known hazards and controls. Confirm in writing that the Ecology Consulting scope is observation only with no handling or removal.	☐ Client contacted ☐ Register obtained & current ☐ Exclusion zones confirmed ☐ Observation-only scope confirmed
Exposure to airborne fibres from nearby asbestos works	Consult with the Principal Contractor and confirm an Asbestos Management Plan is in place. Ensure ecological work is scheduled away from asbestos disturbance activities wherever possible, and never concurrently or downwind. Maintain communication with the site supervisor throughout the day and confirm no removal works have commenced nearby.	☐ AMP confirmed ☐ Work scheduled apart ☐ Upwind position ☐ Supervisor comms
Pre-start inspection and site set-up		
Accidental entry into asbestos zones; tracking contamination between areas	Access only approved areas. Do not enter asbestos work zones under any circumstances. Follow all signage, barricades and permits. Use designated pathways and avoid dusty or contaminated areas. Maintain situational awareness and continuously monitor for changes in site controls.	☐ Approved areas only ☐ Signage followed ☐ Designated pathways
Accidental disturbance of unidentified asbestos found during survey	If suspected asbestos is found: stop work immediately; do not disturb the material; isolate the area; report to the Field Lead, Supervisor and Principal Contractor immediately; and await further instructions. Do not resume work in that area until cleared in writing by the Principal Contractor. Record the location and photograph from a safe distance only where it is safe to do so.	☐ Stop-work rule briefed ☐ Isolation method known ☐ Reporting pathway clear
Undertaking ecological surveys (observation only)		
Fibre exposure or inadvertent disturbance during survey activity	No soil disturbance, excavation, raking, lifting of sheeting or contact with suspect materials is permitted. Maintain distance from ACM. Avoid generating dust — do not drive or walk through dusty areas, and keep vehicle speeds low on unsealed surfaces. Comply with all site controls. Stop work if conditions change.	☐ No ground disturbance ☐ Distance maintained ☐ Dust avoided
Secondary exposure from contaminated surfaces and equipment	Do not place equipment, bags or clothing on the ground in potentially contaminated areas. Prevent the spread of contamination between areas. Follow decontamination instructions where required.	☐ Equipment kept clear ☐ Spread prevented
PPE, hygiene and decontamination		
Inhalation or ingestion of fibres; poor hygiene practice	Minimum PPE is long sleeves, gloves and boots. Where directed by the Principal Contractor, wear disposable coveralls and a P2 respirator, fit-checked in accordance with AS/NZS 1715. No eating, drinking or smoking in work areas. Wash hands prior to all breaks.	☐ Minimum PPE worn ☐ P2 fit-checked ☐ No eat / drink zone ☐ Hands washed
Cross-contamination offsite; exposure from contaminated waste	Follow site decontamination procedures. Remove PPE in a controlled manner; do not shake or blow down clothing. Clean boots and equipment prior to leaving site. Disposable PPE is removed carefully, double-bagged in 200 µm bags, labelled as asbestos waste and disposed of in accordance with site waste procedures.	☐ Decon procedure followed ☐ No shaking of clothing ☐ Boots & equipment cleaned ☐ Waste double-bagged & labelled

Stop-work triggers — stop work immediately, move to a safe location, notify the Field Lead and Principal Contractor, and do not recommence until the risk is controlled and communicated

Suspected asbestos or ACM identified	Asbestos register unavailable or out of date	Asbestos removal works commence nearby	Damage to containment or barricades
Visible dust generation in an ACM area	Exclusion zone breached	Signage or barricades missing	Any uncertainty about material composition

Emergency response

Read with the site-specific Emergency Response Plan. The Field Lead is the Chief Warden. Any worker may activate the ERP.

1 · Activate & make safe	Stop work and ensure the area is safe for responders. Do not move an injured person unless there is immediate danger. For a suspected fibre release or exposure event: stop work immediately, evacuate the area, isolate it if safe to do so, notify the Field Lead, Supervisor and Principal Contractor, follow site emergency procedures, and do not re-enter until cleared. Record the names of all potentially exposed personnel and report the exposure to the WHS Officer for health surveillance advice. The Field Lead assesses the situation, initiates the response, directs evacuation to the Emergency Meeting Point, accounts for all personnel using the Daily Toolbox Talk sign-on sheet, and coordinates communication with the office.
2 · Call for help	Call 000 or 112, or activate the In Reach or PLB where there is no coverage. Provide GPS coordinates and the nearest cross roads, the nature of the emergency and safe access routes. Assign one person to guide responders in.
3 · First aid	A trained first aider assesses the casualty, but only where it is safe to do so. Control bleeding, immobilise suspected fractures and monitor breathing. If unconscious but breathing, place in the recovery position; if not breathing, commence CPR. Record all treatment on the First Aid Treatment Log.
4 · Post-incident	Report to the WHS Officer and complete an Incident Report Form within the required timeframe, submitted through the digital WHS platform. The WHS Officer updates the Incident Register and notifies the regulator of any notifiable incident. Attend debrief; review and update this SWMS and the ERP; restock emergency equipment used. Psychosocial support is provided where workers were exposed to distressing events.

Emergency services	000 or 112	State Emergency Service (SES)	13 25 00
EC office / Check-in Officer	0472 569 988	Managing Director / WHS Officer	Tony Webster · 0448 439 334
Poisons Information Hotline	13 11 26	Wildlife rescue	1300 094 737
Employee Assistance Program	1300 172 327 — free and confidential	Nearest hospital & muster point	Identified per site in the ERP; confirmed at the toolbox talk

Training & competency requirements

Required for this activity	Asbestos Awareness training is mandatory for all personnel attending sites where asbestos is known or suspected (an ACT requirement, and required elsewhere where the Principal Contractor mandates it). Silica Awareness is also an ACT requirement. Respirator wearers must be fit-tested and clean-shaven at the seal.
Baseline — all field personnel	White Card (General Construction Induction); current driver's licence of appropriate class; CPR certification (annual renewal); Provide First Aid (HLTAID011), and Remote First Aid (HLTAID013) for remote or isolated work; General Fauna Handling Training.
Verification	All training must be current, recorded and verifiable prior to mobilisation. Records are maintained by the Administration Officer and retained for a minimum of five years, with expiry notifications issued in advance; workers are not mobilised with expired mandatory training. Competency is verified annually and observed on site by Principal or Senior Ecologists, Project Managers and the WHS Officer. Subcontractor training evidence is collected and retained for audit.

Daily SWMS acknowledgement & sign-on register

All personnel must read, understand and sign this SWMS before commencing work, confirming they are fit for duty, competent and able to perform assigned tasks safely. Completed with the Daily Toolbox Talk and submitted through the digital WHS platform.

#	Name	Role	Signature	Date
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

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